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Questions abound on Clancy holdout juror

Active restraining order, eviction notice raise flags on trial selection process

By Shelley Murphy, Chris Serres, and Shannon Larson
GLOBE STAFF

The lone holdout juror in the Lindsay Clancy trial who was accused of forcing a mistrial has his own history with the justice system, including a past charge for domestic violence — raising deeper questions about the jury selection process in the high-profile case.

The juror is Michael P. Desronvil, 48, of Bridgewater. His personal legal issues were first reported by

NBC10, though he was not identified by name. But the Globe confirmed his identity through photos published online, court records, and an interview with one of his fellow jurors. He had an active civil restraining order against him for allegedly assaulting his nephew and was facing eviction proceedings even as he was weighing evidence against Clancy, who admitted strangling her three children in January 2023 but pleaded not guilty by reason of insanity.

Repeated efforts by the Globe to reach Desronvil were unsuccessful.

The disclosures about Desronvil's legal troubles raise questions about the jury screening before Clancy's trial and could factor into the selection process if another jury is empaneled; the first trial ended in a deadlock after seven days of deliberations, with Desronvil being the only holdout against an acquittal based on insanity. A mistrial was declared Sept. 4 after six weeks of trial.

Plymouth District Attorney Timothy Cruz declined to comment Monday on the jury selection process, according to a spokesperson. He has yet to say whether he will

seek to re-try Clancy on first-degree murder charges, which would require another jury empanelment. If he reduces the charges to second-degree murder, Clancy could waive her right to a jury trial and let a judge decide.

Judge William F. Sullivan has scheduled a hearing Sept. 29 to set a trial date.

One of the jurors, Paula Devlin, told the Globe that she didn't believe Desronvil should have been allowed to sit on the Clancy jury, given the active restraining order. "People make mistakes in their life, but I think something that's pending

JUROR, Page A6

Key call looms for Fed chief, board

New chair Warsh faces pressure from Trump to not hike rates despite inflation

By Jim Puzzanghera
GLOBE STAFF

WASHINGTON — The moment of truth has arrived for new Federal Reserve chair Kevin Warsh: Will he hike interest rates to tackle rising prices, or hold off to try to please the person who appointed him?

After months of unprecedented pressure on the Fed to lower interest rates, President Trump tapped Warsh at the beginning of this year to replace Jerome Powell, who would not comply with Trump's wishes.

Warsh had been publicly supportive of lower rates, but he took office in May vowing to be independent, as the job requires.

Recently, after higher prices caused by the Iran war triggered an inflation jump, Warsh has been vocal about getting it under control. Now it's decision time.

The Fed's monetary policy committee kicks off a two-day meeting Tuesday and will announce its interest rate decision on Wednesday afternoon amid high expectations from investors of the first hike in more than three years.

Kevin Hassett, a top White House economic official, has been clear in public comments recently that is not Trump's preference, particularly

FED, Page A5

Victims detail harrowing attack as Vt. trial opens

'I heard some gunshots and I was on the ground.'

By Paul Heintz
GLOBE STAFF

BURLINGTON, Vt. — As he strolled down a street here on a chilly autumn evening, Tahseen Aliahmad turned to face his childhood friend, Hisham Awartani, conversing in a mix of Arabic and English. When he looked forward again, he saw something surprising: a man pointing a handgun at them.

"I heard some gunshots and I was on the ground," Aliahmad said in Chittenden Superior Court Monday.

He tried to get up but realized he'd been shot in the chest — and that the gunman might still be lurking nearby — so he lay back down beside his friend. "I was playing dead," he said.

Aliahmad's harrowing testimony came at the start of a weeklong trial for the man charged with firing those shots: Jason Eaton, 51, of Burlington. Eaton faces three counts of attempted second-degree murder in the November 2023 shootings of Aliahmad, Awartani, and a third friend, Kinnan Abdalhamid, who had been walking just behind them in the residential neighborhood.

SHOOTINGS, Page A10



PHOTOS BY LANE TURNER/GLOBE STAFF

REAPING TECHNOLOGY, SOWING SEEDS

UMass initiative seeks to have us rethink how we produce food

By Brooke Hauser
GLOBE STAFF

AMHERST Greater Boston is considered the vanguard of biotech, but what if Western Mass. could forge a similar frontier for food? That's what the University of Massachusetts Amherst is banking on with its just-launched, \$120 million Future of Food initiative.

The name might conjure up images of push-button meals and food pills à la "The Jetsons." But with a global population that's projected to hit nearly 10 billion by 2050, the future of food is all about access — and



Lucy Stevens and Winston McGregor (top) loaded a van with produce in a school field in Amherst. Among the produce were radishes.

with climate change threatening natural resources including soil and water, access depends on sustainability.

Now, UMass Amherst is leading the charge to bring together everyone from farmers to food scientists to solve problems facing our global food system. The transformational investment will establish a 36,000-square-foot research facility, a collaborative research center, and an endowed chair in food science, among other positions. It comes in four \$30 million tranches: from the family foundation of private donors Paul

FOOD, Page A6

Justices halt mail-in ballot bid by Trump

Supreme Court said it would cause early voting chaos. **A2.**

The rapper Macklemore said he was told that Robert Kraft barred him from an upcoming concert with Ed Sheeran at Gillette Stadium after he made pro-Palestinian statements. **B6.**

The EPA halted rules limiting greenhouse gas emissions from gas and coal power plants. **A2.**



Matthew Rhys won two lead actor awards at the Emmys. **B6.**

L.L. Bean starts winding trek to \$2b goal

Retailer bets on new stores, new customers, and a huge renovation

By Alexa Gagosz
GLOBE STAFF

FREEPORT, Maine — For more than a century, L.L. Bean's flagship store has been a shrine to New England outdoorsmanship: a 24/7 place to buy its iconic American-made duck boots, wander through the company's sprawling collection of gear — and for many generations of families, make a pilgrimage to a favorite brand's birthplace.

Now L.L. Bean has rebuilt its flagship entirely.

The company is officially reopening the store this weekend after a nearly two-year closure and a \$50 million overhaul, its biggest investment yet in the home of a brand it's protected fiercely for generations.

L.L. BEAN, Page A10



MELECK ELDAHSHOURY FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE

A pair of original duck boots is displayed in the chain's revamped Freeport store.



Turn on delights

Tuesday: Sunny, beautiful. High 65-70, low 54-59.

Wednesday: See above. High 75-80, low 62-67.

Sunrise: 6:24. Sunset: 6:54.

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